

REPTILES



CLASS Reptilia

AFRICAN STRIPED SKINK

Chordates with scaly skin, or reptiles, were the first 4-legged animals to be fully at home on dry land. This is because their skin is waterproof. Snakes and lizards make up over

90 percent of living reptile species, although the largest species are tortoises and crocodiles. Most reptiles lay eggs, but a small minority give birth to live young.

TORTOISES AND TURTLES

ORDER Chelononia FAMILIES 14 SPECIES 346

TUATARAS

ORDER Rhynchocephalia FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 1

SQUAMATES

ORDER Squamata FAMILIES 52 SPECIES 10,000

SNAKES

SUBORDER Serpentes FAMILIES 19 SPECIES c.4,500

BOAS, PYTHONS, AND RELATIVES

SUPERFAMILY Henophoidea FAMILIES 12 SPECIES 218

COLUBRIDS AND RELATIVES

SUPERFAMILY Caenophoidea FAMILIES 3 SPECIES c.4,000

COLUBRIDS

FAMILY Colubridae SPECIES 3,300

VIPERS

FAMILY Viperidae SPECIES 337

ELAPIDS

FAMILY Elapidae SPECIES 361

BLIND AND THREAD SNAKES

SUPERFAMILY Scolecophidia FAMILIES 5 SPECIES 441

LIZARDS

SUBORDER Lacertilia FAMILIES 37 SPECIES c.6,300

IGUANAS AND RELATIVES

SUPERFAMILY Iguanoidea FAMILIES 14 SPECIES 1,840

GECKOS AND SNAKE LIZARDS

SUPERFAMILY Gekkotoidea FAMILIES 7 SPECIES c.1,700

SKINKS AND RELATIVES

SUPERFAMILY Scincomorpoidea FAMILIES 8 SPECIES 2,477

ANGUIMORPH LIZARDS

SUPERFAMILY Anguimorpoidea FAMILIES 9 SPECIES 250

AMPHISBAENIANS

SUBORDER Amphisbaenia FAMILIES 6 SPECIES 196

CROCODILES AND ALLIGATORS

ORDER Crocodilia FAMILIES 3 SPECIES 25

AMPHIBIANS



CLASS Amphibia

PACIFIC GIANT SALAMANDER

Frogs and toads make up the largest order of amphibians, and show the widest range of adaptations for terrestrial life. Newts and

salamanders most closely resemble ancestral amphibians; caecilians are an aberrant and relatively little-known group.

NEWTS AND SALAMANDERS

ORDER Caudata FAMILIES 9 SPECIES 707

CAECILIANS

ORDER Gymnophiona FAMILIES 10 SPECIES 205

FROGS AND TOADS

ORDER Anura FAMILIES 56 SPECIES 6,700

FISHES



AMERICAN PADDLEFISH

Despite similarities, fish are a varied collection of animals with different evolutionary histories. Lampreys and hagfish have no jaws. Bony and cartilaginous fishes have jaws, skulls, and skeletons, but their anatomy is very different,

and their lifestyles distinct. Today, bony fishes make up by far the largest class across aquatic habitats. The major subclass of this group contains so many orders and species that it is dealt with at superorder level in this book.

JAWLESS FISHES

HAGFISH

CLASS Myxini ORDERS 1 FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 78

LAMPREYS

CLASS Cephalaspidomorphi ORDERS 1 FAMILIES 1 SPECIES c.43

CARTILAGINOUS FISHES

CLASS Chondrichthyes ORDERS 14 FAMILIES 54 SPECIES c.1,200

SHARKS AND RAYS

SUBCLASS Euselachii

SHARKS

ORDERS 9 FAMILIES 34 SPECIES C.510

RAY

ORDERS 4 FAMILIES 17 SPECIES C.650

CHIMAERAS

SUBCLASS Holocephali ORDERS 1 FAMILIES 3 SPECIES 48

BONY FISHES

CLASS Osteichthyes ORDERS 67 FAMILIES 481 SPECIES c.31,000

FLESHY-FINNED FISHES

SUBCLASS Sarcopterygii ORDERS 2 FAMILIES 4 SPECIES 48

RAY-FINNED FISHES

SUBCLASS Actinopterygii

PRIMITIVE RAY-FINNED FISHES

ORDERS 4 FAMILIES 5 SPECIES 49

BONY-TONGUED FISHES

ORDER Osteoglossiformes FAMILIES 5 SPECIES 244

TARPONS AND EELS

SUPERORDER Elopomorpha ORDERS 4 FAMILIES 24 SPECIES C.1,000

HERRINGS AND RELATIVES

SUPERORDER Clupeomorpha ORDERS 1 FAMILIES 5 SPECIES 405

SLICKHEADS AND TUBESHOULDERS

SUPERORDER Alepocephali ORDERS 1 FAMILIES 3 SPECIES 137

CATFISH AND RELATIVES

SUPERORDER Ostariophysi ORDERS 5 FAMILIES 85 SPECIES C.10,500

SALMON AND RELATIVES

SUPERORDER Protacanthopterygii ORDERS 2 FAMILIES 14 SPECIES 355

SMELTS AND DRAGONFISHES

SUPERORDER Osmeromorpha ORDERS 4 FAMILIES 14 SPECIES c.600

LANTERNFISH AND RELATIVES

SUPERORDER Scoleporomorpha ORDERS 2 FAMILIES 19 SPECIES C.520
SUPERORDER Cyclostromata ORDERS 1 FAMILIES 1 SPECIES C.13

OPAHS AND OARFISHES

SUPERORDER Lamprimorpha ORDERS 1 FAMILIES 6 SPECIES c.22

CODFISHES AND RELATIVES

SUPERORDER Paracanthopterygii ORDERS 5 FAMILIES 24 SPECIES C.667

SPINY-RAYED FISHES

SUPERORDER Acanthopterygii ORDERS 34 FAMILIES 284 SPECIES c.14,800